MyAccounting — User Guide

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1. Introduction

MyAccounting is a desktop accounting application for small Canadian service-industry businesses. It covers the complete accounts-receivable (AR) cycle and general-ledger workflow, including:

- Invoice creation and PDF delivery
- Cash receipt recording
- Double-entry general journal entries
- Chart of Accounts maintenance with transaction drill-down
- Trial Balance, Income Statement, and Balance Sheet reports
- Consultant timesheet management with client email delivery

The application runs on Windows and connects to a local Microsoft SQL Server database.

2. System Requirements

Requirement	Details
Operating System	Windows 10 or later
SQL Server	Local instance, database `myaccounting`, Windows Authentication enabled
ODBC Driver	ODBC Driver 17 for SQL Server
Python *(source only)*	3.9 or later

If you are running from the compiled executable (`MyAccounting.exe`), Python does not need to be installed separately.

3. First-Time Setup

Perform these steps **once** on a fresh installation before launching the application for the first time.

Step 1 — Create the Database

Using SQL Server Management Studio (or `sqlcmd`), create an empty database named `myaccounting` on your local SQL Server instance. Windows Authentication must be enabled.

Step 2 — Import Seed Data

Open a command prompt in the application folder and run:

```
python import_data.py
```

This reads the files in the `importdir/` folder and populates the initial Chart of Accounts, customers, inventory items, and projects.

> **Important:** Run this script **once only**. Running it again on an existing database will cause duplicate-key errors.

Step 3 — Launch the Application

```
python app.py
```

(or double-click `MyAccounting.exe` if using the standalone build)

On first launch, all remaining database tables are created automatically and the default `admin` account is seeded.

Step 4 — Change the Admin Password

Log in with the default credentials:

Field	Value
Username	`admin`
Password	`admin`

Immediately go to **Configuration** → **Users**, select the `admin` account, and set a strong password.

Step 5 — Configure Company Information

Go to **Configuration** and complete at minimum:

- **Company Info** — name, address, phone, email
- **Fiscal Year & Settings** — fiscal year dates, tax rate, G/L account mappings
- **Email Settings** — SMTP host/port and credentials (required for email features)

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4. Logging In

Every time the application starts, the **Login** dialog is displayed.

1. Enter your **Username** and **Password**.
2. Click **Sign In**.

If you click **Cancel**, the application closes immediately.

> Passwords are stored using PBKDF2-HMAC SHA-256 with 260,000 iterations — they are never stored in plain text.

Forgotten Password

Only an administrator can reset a user's password. Contact your admin to have it reset via **Configuration** → **Users** → **Reset Password**.

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5. Dashboard

After login, the **Dashboard** is the home screen. It gives a live overview of your company's financial position.

Panels

Panel	Description
AR Balances	Outstanding receivables by customer. Shows each customer's current balance due.
In-Process Journals	Number of journal entries with `Draft` status (not yet posted).
Revenue Chart	Bar chart of monthly revenue drawn from the G/L revenue account.
To-Do List	Personal task list (per logged-in user).

Using the To-Do List

Action	How
Add a task	Click **Add Task**, fill in Title, Notes, Due Date, and Priority, then save.
Complete a task	Select the task and click **Mark Complete**.
Delete a task	Select the task and click **Delete**.

Priority levels: `Low`, `Normal`, `High`.

To return to the Dashboard from any module, click the **Home** (house) icon or the application name in the sidebar.

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6. Configuration

Configuration is the administrative hub of the application. Click **Configuration** in the sidebar to open it.

> Only users with *full* access to the Configuration module (or the `admin` role) can reach this area.

The module is organised into **13 tabs**. The most important tabs for initial setup are described below.

6.1 Company Info

Enter your company's legal name, mailing address, phone, fax, email address, website, and optional logo. This information appears on printed invoices and reports.

6.2 Fiscal Year & Settings

Field	Description
Fiscal Year Start / End	Default date range used when generating reports
Tax Rate (%)	Applied as HST on all invoices (default: `13.00` for Ontario)
Currency	Display currency (default: `CAD`)
Invoice Prefix	Text prepended to invoice numbers (default: `INV-`)
Journal Prefix	Text prepended to journal entry numbers
Receipt Prefix	Text prepended to cash receipt numbers (default: `CR-`)
AR Account	G/L account number for Accounts Receivable
Revenue Account	G/L account number for Revenue
Tax Payable Account	G/L account number for HST/Tax Payable
Bank/Cash Account	G/L account number for your bank account

> The AR, Revenue, Tax, and Bank account fields must be filled in before you can post invoices, cash receipts, or journal entries.

6.3 Customers

Manage your customer list (add, edit, delete). Each customer record includes:

- Billing and shipping addresses
- Assigned salesman, tax code, and payment terms
- Credit limit and default revenue G/L account
- Client manager contact details (used for timesheet emails)
- Preferred language and notes

6.4 Inventory (Service Items)

Define billable service items (e.g., “Consulting Services”, “Project Management”). Each item has:

- Item Code and Description
- Unit of Measure and Unit Price
- Default Revenue G/L account

Items are selected when creating invoice line items.

6.5 Projects, Salesmen, Tax Codes, Payment Terms

Manage the lookup tables referenced throughout the application. All support full add/edit/delete.

6.6 Email Settings

Enter the SMTP details required for sending emails from the application:

Field	Description
SMTP Host	Mail server hostname (e.g., `smtp.office365.com`)
SMTP Port	Usually `587` for TLS or `465` for SSL
Username / Password	SMTP account credentials
Use TLS	Enable STARTTLS (recommended)
Support Email	Destination address for support requests

6.7 Users

(Admin-only tab) See Section 13 — User Management.

6.8 Timesheet Settings

Setting	Description
Default Shift Type	`8to4` or `9to5` — preset start/end times for new timesheet rows
Require Approval	If enabled, emailed timesheets include an approval-request message

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7. Invoicing

Click **Invoicing** in the sidebar to open the Invoicing module.

7.1 Invoice List

All invoices are displayed in a list showing:

- Invoice Number, Date, Customer, Total, Status

Click any invoice to select it. Use the toolbar buttons to **New**, **Edit**, **Delete**, **Print PDF**, or **Email** the selected invoice.

7.2 Creating an Invoice

1. Click **New Invoice**.
2. Fill in the header fields:

Field	Required	Description
Invoice Date	Yes	Date of the invoice (MM/DD/YYYY)
Customer	Yes	Select from the customer list
Salesman	No	Assigned salesman
Project	No	Related project
Comments	No	Free-text note printed on the invoice

3. Add line items by clicking **Add Line**:
    - Select an **Item** from the inventory list.
    - Adjust **Quantity** and **Unit Price** if needed.
    - The **Amount** is calculated automatically.
    - Use **Add Text Line** for section headers or notes that do not affect the total.
4. The **Subtotal**, **HST**, and **Total** are calculated automatically at the bottom.
5. Click **Save** to save as `Draft`.

7.3 Invoice Status Lifecycle

```
Draft  ──[Approve]──►  Approved  ──[Void]──►  Void
```

- **Draft** — Editable. Included in AR Balances on the Dashboard.
- **Approved** — Read-only. Included in AR Balances.
- **Void** — Read-only. Excluded from AR balance calculations.

7.4 Printing a PDF Invoice

Select an invoice and click **Print PDF** (or **Preview PDF**). A professionally formatted PDF is generated using your company header, logo, and invoice details.

7.5 Emailing an Invoice

1. Ensure the customer has a billing email address in **Configuration** → **Customers**.
2. Ensure SMTP settings are configured in **Configuration** → **Email Settings**.
3. Select the invoice and click **Email Invoice**.
4. Confirm the recipient and click **Send**.

The PDF invoice is attached automatically.

7.6 Managing Attachments

Use the **Attachments** button on an open invoice to link supporting documents (contracts, purchase orders, etc.) to the invoice record.

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8. Cash Receipts

Click **Cash Receipts** in the sidebar.

8.1 Recording a Payment

1. Click **New Receipt**.
2. Fill in the fields:

Field	Required	Description
Receipt Date	Yes	Date the payment was received
Customer	Yes	Who made the payment
Amount	Yes	Payment amount (must be > 0)
Invoice	No	Optionally link to an open invoice
Bank Account	Yes	G/L account for the bank/cash deposit
AR Account	Yes	G/L account for Accounts Receivable
Memo	No	Reference note

3. Click **Save** to save as `Draft`.
4. Review the verification listing to confirm the G/L entries.
5. Click **Post** to post the receipt.

8.2 What Happens When You Post

Posting a cash receipt creates two G/L entries:

Account	Entry
Bank/Cash account	Debit (money coming in)
Accounts Receivable account	Credit (reducing what the customer owes)

> **Posted receipts are final.** They cannot be edited or deleted after posting. Verify before posting.

8.3 Cash Receipt Status

Status	Description
`Draft`	Editable; not yet reflected in the G/L
`Posted`	Permanently recorded; read-only

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9. General Journal

Click **Journal** in the sidebar to open the General Journal module.

9.1 Journal Entry List

The list shows all journal entries with their number, date, description, reference, and status. Select an entry and use the toolbar to **New**, **Edit**, **Delete** (Draft only), **View**, or **Post**.

9.2 Creating a Journal Entry

1. Click **New Entry**.
2. Fill in the header:

Field	Required	Description
Entry Date	Yes	Date of the transaction (MM/DD/YYYY)
Description	Yes	Brief explanation of the entry
Reference	No	External reference (cheque number, etc.)

3. Add detail lines by clicking **Add Line**:
   - **Account** — G/L account number (must exist in the Chart of Accounts)
   - **Description** — Line-level description
   - **Debit / Credit** — Enter the amount on the appropriate side
4. The running totals at the bottom show total Debits and total Credits in real time. They **must be equal** before you can post.
5. Click **Save** to save as `Draft`.

9.3 Posting a Journal Entry

1. With a `Draft` entry selected, click **Verify** to preview the G/L entries.
2. Click **Post** to post the entry.

Posting inserts all detail lines into `gldetails` and updates the G/L summary.

> **Validation rules:** At least two lines are required. Total debits must equal total credits. All account numbers must exist in the Chart of Accounts.

9.4 Journal Entry Status

Status	Description
`Draft`	Editable; not yet in the G/L
`Posted`	Permanently recorded; read-only

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10. Chart of Accounts (G/L)

Click **Chart of Accounts** (or **G/L**) in the sidebar.

10.1 Account List

All G/L accounts are displayed with their account number, name, type, balance type, opening balance, and current net balance.

- Click a column header to sort by that column.
- Select an account and click **Transactions** to see the full transaction history for that account.

10.2 Managing Accounts

Action	How
Add account	Click **New Account**, enter account number, name, type, and balance type (`Dr` or `Cr`)
Edit account	Select an account and click **Edit**
Delete account	Select an account and click **Delete** — only allowed if the account has no transaction history

10.3 Account Types

Standard account type ranges used in reporting:

Account Range	Type	Report Section
1000 – 1999	Asset	Balance Sheet
2000 – 2999	Liability	Balance Sheet
3000 – 3999	Equity	Balance Sheet
4000 – 4999	Revenue	Income Statement
5000 – 9999	Expense	Income Statement

10.4 Net Balance Calculation

Net balances are always calculated live from transaction history:

- **Debit-normal accounts (Assets, Expenses):** `Opening Balance + Σ Debits − Σ Credits`
- **Credit-normal accounts (Liabilities, Equity, Revenue):** `Opening Balance + Σ Credits − Σ Debits`

10.5 Exporting the Chart of Accounts

Use the **Export** button to export the account list to:

- **CSV** — for use in spreadsheet applications
- **Excel (.xlsx)** — formatted workbook with styled headers
- **PDF** — formatted document with company header

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11. Financial Reports

Click **Reports** in the sidebar.

Three standard financial reports are available.

11.1 Available Reports

Report	Accounts Used	Description
Trial Balance	All accounts	Lists every account with its net debit or credit balance. Total debits must equal total credits.
Income Statement	4000 – 9999	Revenue minus expenses for a selected date range. Shows net income or net loss.
Balance Sheet	1000 – 3999	Assets, liabilities, and equity as at a selected date.

11.2 Generating a Report

1. Select the report type from the panel.
2. Adjust the **Start Date** and **End Date** if needed (default to fiscal year settings).
3. Click **Generate**.
4. The report is displayed on screen in the module panel.

11.3 Exporting a Report

After generating, use the export buttons:

Format	Description
PDF	Formatted multi-page report with company header and page numbers
Excel (.xlsx)	Styled workbook with bold headers and currency formatting

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12. Timesheets

Click **Timesheets** in the sidebar.

12.1 Timesheet List

Filter the list by **Year**, **Month**, and **Consultant Name** using the dropdowns at the top. Each row shows the timesheet ID, consultant, month/year, client, status, and total hours.

12.2 Creating a Timesheet

1. Click **New Timesheet**.
2. Fill in the header:

Field	Required	Description
Consultant (Salesman)	Yes	The consultant this timesheet belongs to
Year / Month	Yes	The billing period
Client	Yes	Customer associated with this timesheet
Project	No	Related project
Notes	No	General notes

3. Click **Save** to create the timesheet header.
4. Add daily entries by selecting a date row and clicking **Add Work Item**:
    - Enter a **Description** of the work performed
    - Enter an optional **Azure DevOps Work Item** reference number
    - Enter **Start** and **End** times for AM, PM, and/or Other shifts
    - Hours are calculated automatically from the time entries

> Only one timesheet per consultant per calendar month is allowed.

12.3 Time Entry Format

Enter times in any of these formats: `9:00`, `09:00`, `0900`, `9:30`. The system normalises all entries to `HH:MM`.

12.4 Timesheet Status Workflow

```
Draft  ──[Submit]──►  Submitted  ──[Approve]──►  Approved
                                 ──[Reject] ──►  Rejected

Rejected  ──[Reset to Draft]──►  Draft
```

Status	Who Can Act	Allowed Actions
`Draft`	Consultant	Edit, Submit, Delete
`Submitted`	Manager/Admin	Approve, Reject
`Rejected`	Consultant	View, Reset to Draft
`Approved`	—	Read-only; Print, Email

12.5 Printing a Timesheet PDF

Select a timesheet and click **Print PDF**. A professionally formatted landscape-orientation PDF is generated showing consultant info, the daily grid with work items, and the monthly total hours.

12.6 Emailing a Timesheet to the Client

1. Ensure the customer record has a **Manager Email** address in **Configuration** → **Customers**.
2. Ensure SMTP settings are configured in **Configuration** → **Email Settings**.
3. Select an **Approved** timesheet and click **Send to Client**.
4. The PDF is attached and sent to the client manager's email.

12.7 Importing a TPG Timesheet

To import a timesheet from an external TPG-format file:

1. Click **Import TPG Timesheet**.
2. Browse to and select your source file (CSV, PDF, or Excel).
3. Review the preview dialog showing the parsed rows.
4. Click **Confirm** to import or **Cancel** to discard.

Supported import formats:

Format	Notes
CSV	Standard comma-separated file
PDF (text-based)	Extracted with `pdfplumber`
PDF (scanned)	OCR fallback via `easyocr`
Excel (.xlsx)	Read with `openpyxl`

13. User Management

(Admin access required) Go to **Configuration** → **Users**.

13.1 User Roles

Role	Description
`admin`	Full access to all modules, including the Users tab. Cannot be restricted.
`user`	Access to modules is controlled individually via the access level settings.

13.2 Adding a User

1. Click **Add User**.
2. Enter the user's full name, username, email address, and a temporary password.
3. Select the role (`admin` or `user`).
4. For `user` role accounts, set the access level for each module.
5. Click **Save**.

A welcome email with login instructions is sent to the new user's email address automatically (requires SMTP to be configured).

13.3 Module Access Levels

For non-admin users, each module can be set to one of the following:

Level	Effect
`full`	User can read and write; all action buttons are enabled
`view only`	Module opens in read-only mode; write action buttons are disabled

Modules covered by access control: G/L Chart of Accounts, Journal Entry, Reports, Configuration, Invoicing, Cash Receipts, Timesheets.

13.4 Resetting a Password

1. Select the user in the list.
2. Click **Reset Password**.
3. Enter and confirm the new password.
4. Click **Save**.

13.5 Deactivating a User

Select the user and uncheck **Active**. Inactive users cannot log in. Their historical data is preserved.

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14. Email Features

Several modules can send email directly from the application. All email uses your configured SMTP settings (**Configuration** → **Email Settings**).

Feature	Module	Trigger
Email an invoice	Invoicing	**Email Invoice** button
Email a timesheet	Timesheets	**Send to Client** button
Send a support request	Main toolbar	**Support** button
New user welcome	Configuration → Users	Automatically on user creation

If an email fails to send, check:

1. SMTP credentials are correct in **Configuration** → **Email Settings**.
2. The recipient's email address is entered on the customer or user record.
3. Your network allows outbound connections on the configured SMTP port.

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15. Exporting Data

From the Chart of Accounts module

- **Export** → **CSV** — Account list with balances
- **Export** → **Excel** — Formatted `.xlsx` workbook
- **Export** → **PDF** — Formatted PDF document

From the Reports module

- **Export PDF** — After generating any report
- **Export Excel** — After generating any report

From the Timesheet module

- **Export Excel** — Exports the timesheet detail to a formatted `.xlsx` workbook

Accountant's Export

The `exportdir/accountant.csv` file is the standard G/L summary export. Use the G/L module's export function to refresh this file.

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16. Keyboard & Navigation Tips

Action	Tip
Navigate sidebar	Click the module name or icon in the left sidebar
Return to Dashboard	Click the application name or Home icon in the sidebar
Sort a list	Click any column header to sort ascending/descending
Confirm dialogs	Press **Enter** to confirm the default button
Dismiss dialogs	Press **Escape** to cancel most dialogs
Date fields	Click the calendar icon to use the date picker, or type the date in `MM/DD/YYYY` format

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17. Troubleshooting

"Cannot connect to database"

- Verify that SQL Server is running on `localhost`.
- Verify that a database named `myaccounting` exists.
- Verify that the ODBC Driver 17 for SQL Server is installed.
- Ensure your Windows account has access to the SQL Server instance (Windows Authentication).

"Login failed — account not found or inactive"

- Check that the username is typed correctly (case-insensitive).
- An administrator may have deactivated the account — contact your admin.

PDF invoice/report does not open

- Verify that `reportlab` is installed: `pip install reportlab`.
- Check that the output folder (e.g., `exportdir/`) is not read-only.

Email fails to send

- Confirm SMTP host, port, username, and password in **Configuration** → **Email Settings**.
- If using Microsoft 365 or Gmail, ensure App Passwords or SMTP access is enabled on the account.
- Check firewall rules for outbound TCP on port 587 (or 465).

TPG timesheet import finds no rows

- Ensure the file format matches one of the supported types (CSV, PDF, Excel).
- For PDF files, verify that the PDF is text-based (not a scanned image) or install `easyocr` for OCR support.

Invoice totals look wrong

- Confirm the **Tax Rate** in **Configuration** → **Fiscal Year & Settings** is correct.
- Check that item unit prices are entered correctly in **Configuration** → **Inventory**.

Duplicate serial numbers after re-running import

- `import_data.py` is designed to run **once only**. Do not re-run it on an existing database. Restore from backup if duplicate data was inserted.

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*For further assistance, use the **Support** button in the main toolbar to send a support request to the system administrator.*